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Technology Parks Corporation*

IDEATION PROGRAMME HANDBOOK

V11

<https://www.hkstp.org/en/programmes/ideation>
ideation@hkstp.org

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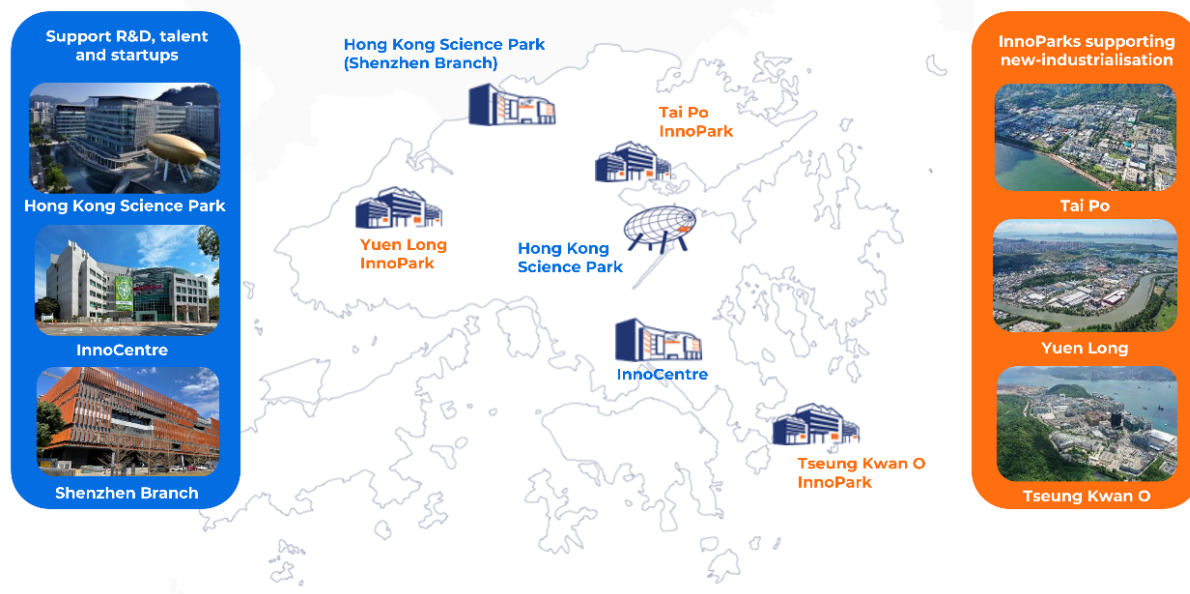
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Chapter 1. Welcome to Ideation

LARGEST I&T ECOSYSTEM IN THE CITY



Building the Next Generation of Technology Ventures

Welcome to the HKSTP Ideation Programme.

Starting a venture is an exciting journey, but it can also be filled with uncertainty and challenges. While innovative ideas are important, successful startups are built through continuous learning, validation, execution and resilience.

The Ideation Programme is HKSTP's pre-incubation programme designed to help aspiring entrepreneurs and early-stage founders validate their ideas, develop entrepreneurial capabilities, build meaningful industry connections and prepare for future growth.

Over the next 12 months, you will gain access to funding support, founder development opportunities, mentorship, ecosystem resources, business networks and growth opportunities designed to accelerate your startup journey.

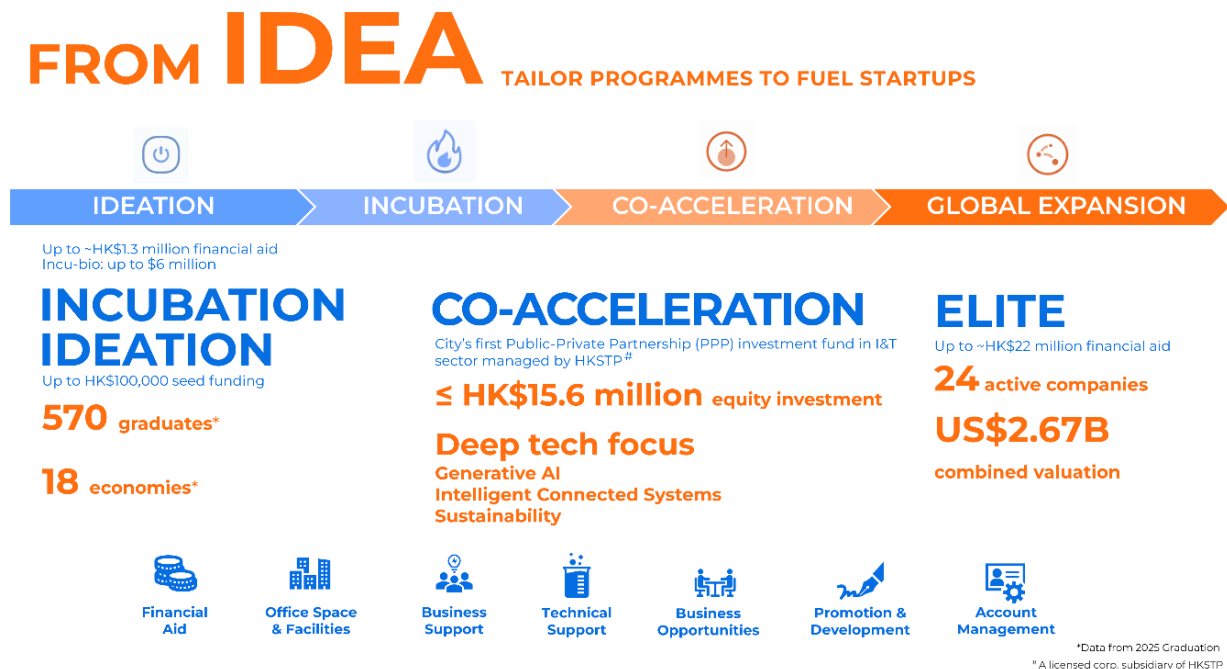
This handbook serves as your guide throughout the programme. It explains what to expect, how to make the most of available resources and what is required to successfully complete the programme.

While HKSTP provides funding, training and ecosystem support, the success of each venture ultimately depends on the commitment, initiative and execution of its founding team.

The HKSTP Startup Journey

Ideation is the starting point of HKSTP's startup development pathway.

As startups mature, they may progress through the following stages:



Each stage is designed to address different startup needs, from idea validation and venture formation to fundraising, business expansion and scaling.

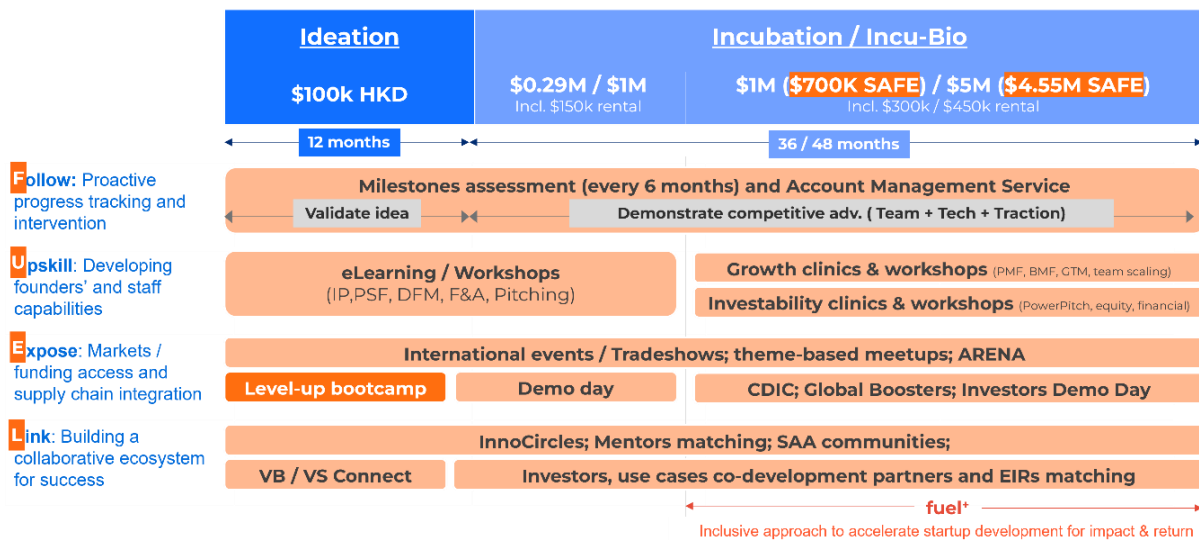
As Hong Kong's leading technology incubator, HKSTP supports approximately 1,400 startups and has nurtured more than 3,700 graduates through its startup programmes. Through a network of over 500 corporate partners and more than 210 investors, HKSTP provides founders with opportunities to access markets, build partnerships and connect with potential investors.

By joining Ideation, you become part of one of Hong Kong's largest innovation and technology ecosystems.

The FUEL Framework

The Ideation Programme is built around the FUEL Framework:

FUEL your Early-stage Startup Journey



FOLLOW

Track progress, achieve milestones and validate your venture.

UPSKILL

Develop founder capabilities and entrepreneurial competencies.

EXPOSE

Access opportunities, markets, customers, and investors.

LINK

Leverage the power of the ecosystem through meaningful connections.

Throughout this handbook, activities and resources are organised according to the FUEL framework.

Chapter 2. FOLLOW

Turning Ideas into Evidence

Many startups fail not because they lack innovative ideas, but because they invest too much time and effort building solutions before validating whether they are solving the right problem.

FOLLOW focuses on helping founders make measurable progress through structured milestones, validation activities and continuous assessment. Members are encouraged to gather evidence, engage customers and test assumptions before making major business decisions.

The Ideation Journey

The programme consists of three milestone stages represented by badges. A detailed programme timeline can be found in Chapter 7.



Silver Badge

The Silver Badge establishes the foundations of the programme journey.

Members establish the necessary programme foundations, including administrative setup, onboarding activities, and access to programme resources.

Achieving the Silver Badge demonstrates readiness to begin the venture-building journey.

Gold Badge

The Gold Badge focuses on problem-solution fit validation.

The Gold Badge assesses a startup's progress towards problem validation, customer validation and business readiness. Strong submissions typically present evidence and insights gathered from customer engagement, market validation activities, prototype development, and team execution, rather than statements alone.

To support members in preparing their submissions, a *Second Milestone FAQ* is available in the [PartnersConnect Portal](#) > **Ideation Library** > **Cohort folder**.

Company Establishment Requirement (Individual Members Only)

Individual Members must establish a Hong Kong company before completing the Second Milestone assessment. The company must satisfy all the following requirements:

- Incorporated as a **private company limited by shares**
- The **Person in Charge (PIC)** must be one of the shareholders
- Incorporated in Hong Kong **less than two years before the application start date**
- The company address must not use **HKSTP** or **InnoCentre** as its registered business address

Platinum Badge

The Platinum Badge represents readiness for progression to HKSTP Incubation programmes.

Members are expected to:

- Submit an Incubation or Incu-Bio application within the programme period
- Successfully receive approval from the relevant assessment panel

The goal of Ideation is not only programme completion but progression to the next stage of startup development.

Chapter 3. UPSKILL

Founders Are Built, Not Born

Building a startup requires more than technical knowledge or domain expertise. Successful founders continuously develop their skills in areas such as customer discovery, business strategy, communication, finance and leadership.

UPSKILL is designed to help members build these capabilities throughout the programme.

Founder Development Series

The Founder Development Series provides practical learning opportunities delivered by entrepreneurs, professors, investors and industry leaders.

Key learning themes may include:

- Entrepreneurship and opportunity discovery
- Market validation
- Business planning
- Business model design
- Pitching and storytelling

Members are encouraged to actively engage with speakers and fellow founders throughout the learning journey.



Highlights :

- ☀️ Learn from those who have built, mentored, and invested in startups.
- 💛 Connect with fellow aspiring entrepreneurs.
- 🎟️ Limited seats available. Applications opening soon.

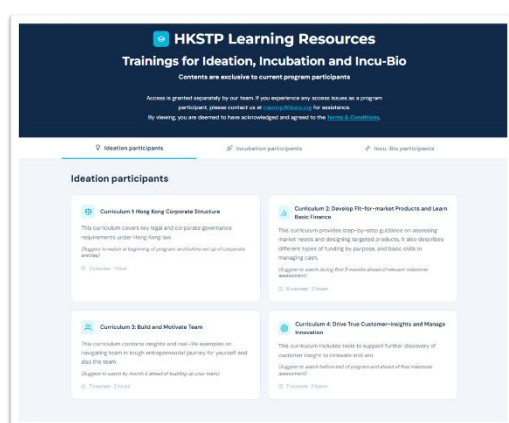
Our Upskill Team has crafted a Founder Development Series, while the first 4 workshops are first-come-first served, and the last pitching workshop is by invite only.

Continuous Learning with Online Resources

Learning does not end with workshops.

Through online learning resources, recorded content, and self-directed exploration, members can continue developing skills at their own pace throughout the programme period.

The founders who derive the greatest value from Ideation are often those who take ownership of their own learning journey.



22 Expert-Led Training Videos

Learn from mentors, professors, industry experts, and investors

4 Structured Learning Pathways

A guided journey from idea validation to business growth

1 Entrepreneurship Fundamentals Challenge (Quiz)

Assess your knowledge and identify learning gaps

For access, please refer to the email “Your Entrepreneurial Journey Starts...Access HKSTP Training Videos” sent at the start of the programme. For enquiries regarding training resources, learning assignments or access issues, please contact the **Upskill Team** at training@hkstp.org.

Chapter 4. EXPOSE

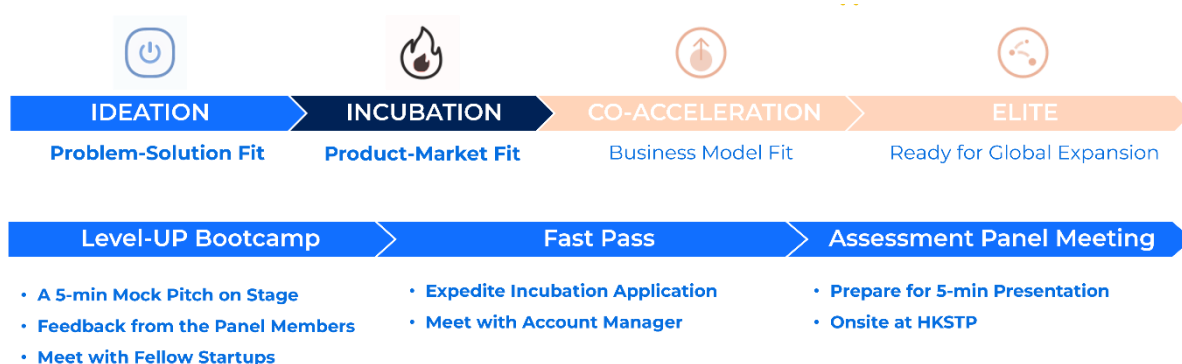
Opportunities Accelerate Growth

Building a successful startup requires exposure to customers, markets, investors and growth opportunities.

EXPOSE helps members gain visibility, expand their networks and explore opportunities beyond their immediate environments.

Level-Up Bootcamp: Empower Your Journey to Incubation

Eligibility: Company Members who have successfully passed the 2nd Milestone.



The Bootcamp provides members with opportunities to:

- Refine their pitch
- Receive expert feedback
- Meet ecosystem stakeholders



Global Opportunities

Eligibility: Company Members who have successfully passed the 2nd Milestone.



**CES 2026
Las Vegas**



**MWC 2026
Spain**



**Global Booster 2026
Europe**



**MWC 2025
Spain**



**CES 2025
Las Vegas**

Eligible members may have opportunities to join local and international startup activities such as:

- Consumer Electronics Show (CES)
- Mobile World Congress (MWC)
- Overseas missions and trade exhibitions

These opportunities allow members to:

- Explore international markets
- Build business relationships
- Gain customer insights
- Increase global visibility

Participation is subject to eligibility, availability and programme arrangements.

TechXchange: Connect with Industry and Business Opportunities

Eligibility: Company Members who have successfully passed the 2nd Milestone.

TechXchange is HKSTP's open innovation platform that connects startups with corporates, enterprises and organisations seeking innovative technology solutions.

Through TechXchange, startups can:

- Discover innovation and business opportunities
- Explore pilot projects and proof-of-concept collaborations
- Connect with potential customers and industry partners
- Increase visibility within the innovation ecosystem
- Respond to innovation challenges and business demands

TechXchange enables founders to engage directly with potential users and industry stakeholders, supporting the transition from product development to commercial adoption.

Portal: <https://portal.hkstp.org/en>

For enquiries regarding TechXchange and opportunities, please contact portal@hkstp.org.

Chapter 5. LINK

Success Is Built Through Connections

The Ideation Programme provides access to a network of founders, mentors, industry experts, investors, corporates and ecosystem partners. As startups progress beyond idea validation, these connections become increasingly important for business growth, fundraising, recruitment and market access.

LINK helps members engage with the wider HKSTP ecosystem and unlock opportunities beyond the programme itself.

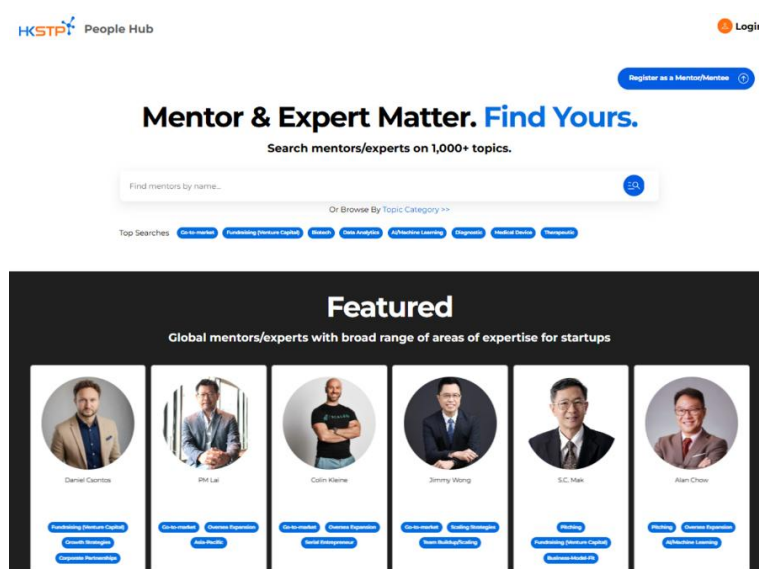
PeopleHub: Learn from Mentors

Eligibility: Company Members who have successfully passed the 2nd Milestone.

PeopleHub is HKSTP's ecosystem engagement platform, connecting startups with mentors, industry experts, investors and other members of the innovation community. Eligible members may access learning resources, mentorship opportunities and ecosystem engagement activities through the platform.

Through PeopleHub, founders can:

- Access mentor matching opportunities
- Connect with industry experts and ecosystem stakeholders



For enquiries regarding PeopleHub or mentorship opportunities, please contact the Community Enrichment team at mentorship@hkstp.org.

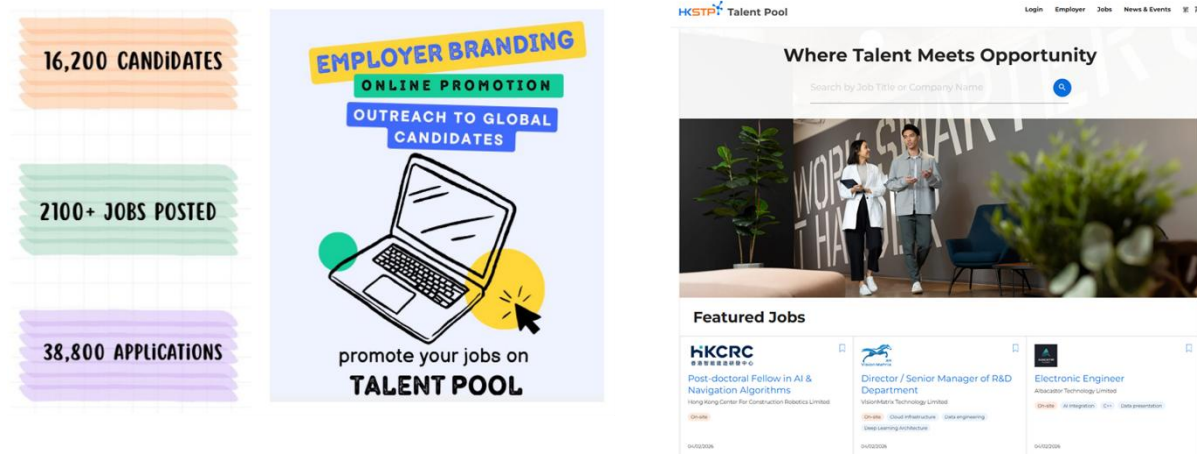
Talent Pool: Build Your Team

Eligibility: Company Members. To update to a Company Member, please refer to Chapter 7 > Change Requests > Company Membership Update.

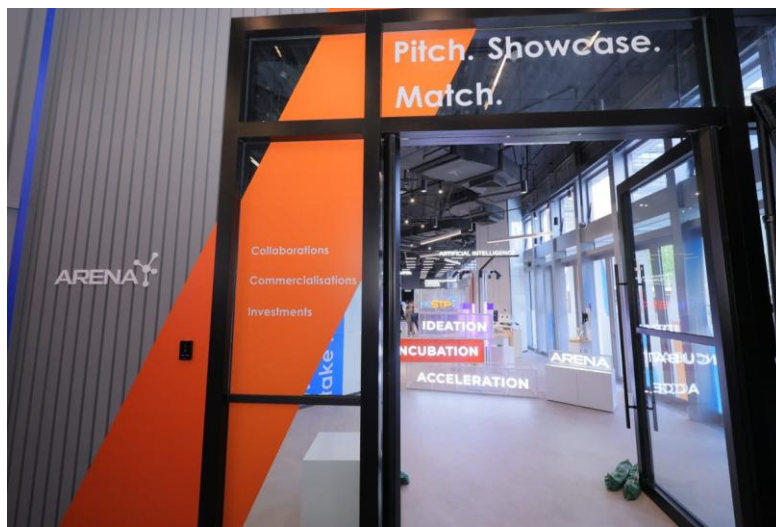
A strong team is one of the most important factors in startup success.

The HKSTP Talent Pool platform helps startups connect with students, graduates and professionals who are interested in innovation and technology careers. Members may leverage the platform to identify potential team members, interns and specialists to support venture growth.

Members are encouraged to actively build their networks and talent pipeline throughout the programme period.



Investor Access & Investment Clinic



While fundraising may not be an immediate priority for every startup, understanding how investors evaluate opportunities can help founders make better business decisions and prepare for future growth.

Through HKSTP's investor engagement initiatives, members may access:

- Investor sharing sessions
- Investment clinics
- Investment readiness workshops
- Investor networking opportunities

Weekly Investment Clinic at ARENA

ARENA is HKSTP's startup pitching, showcasing and matching centre, designed to connect ventures with investors and business opportunities.

The HKSTP Investment Engagement Team hosts a regular **Investment Clinic every Wednesday from 2:00 PM to 5:00 PM at Hong Kong Science Park**. Founders can seek guidance on fundraising strategy, investor expectations, pitch preparation and investment readiness.

For enquiries or registration, please contact the **Investor Engagement Team** at capital@hkstp.org.

Community Engagement

HKSTP is home to a diverse community of entrepreneurs, startups, mentors, investors, researchers and corporate partners.

Members are encouraged to join community activities throughout the year, including networking events, workshops, sharing sessions, festive celebrations, sports activities and other interest-based gatherings.

Many valuable partnerships, customer introductions and opportunities begin through conversations within the ecosystem.



Stay Connected

A weekly community newsletter is sent to the registered **PIC email address**, featuring upcoming events, workshops, ecosystem opportunities and community updates.

Members are encouraged to review the newsletter regularly and make the most of the opportunities available across the HKSTP ecosystem.



Expand Your Network

Connect with fellow entrepreneurs, investors, executives and mentors through HKSTP's community platforms and networking channels.

Simply scan to connect and grow your network within Hong Kong's innovation ecosystem.



Often, a single conversation can create unexpected opportunities.

Alumni Network

Towards the end of the programme, members will receive an invitation to join the HKSTP Startups Alumni Association (SAA) upon completion of the programme survey. For enquiries regarding the Startups Alumni Association and community activities, please contact saa@hkstp.org.

Chapter 6. Ecosystem Support & Resources

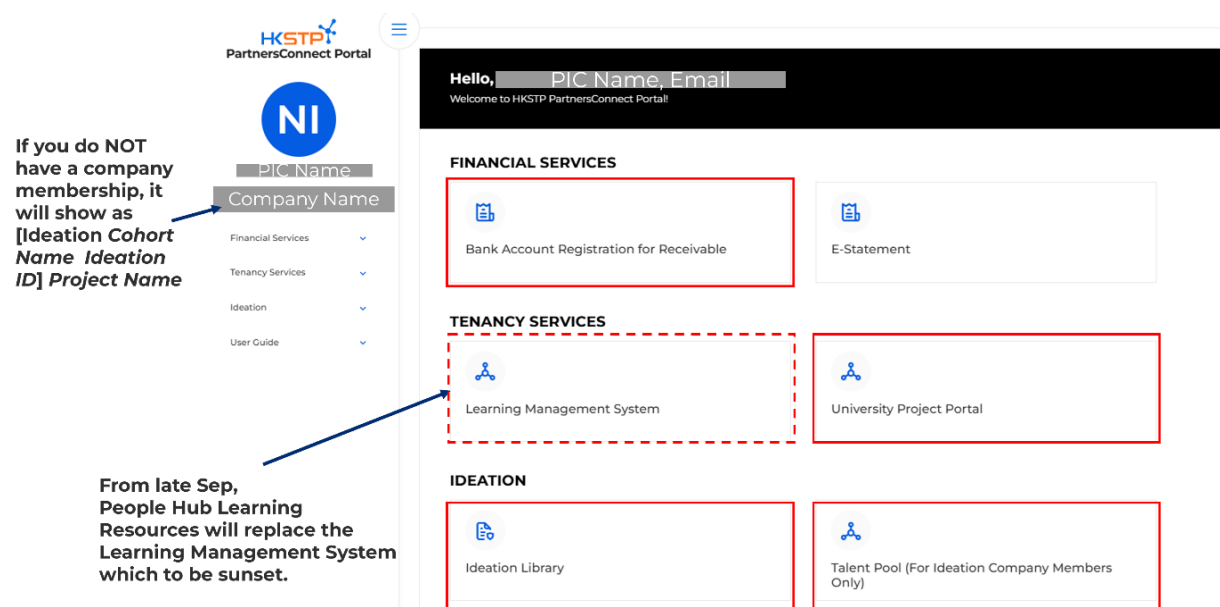


Making the Most of Your Membership

Beyond training and funding, Ideation members have access to a range of ecosystem tools, facilities and support resources.

PartnersConnect Portal and Ideation Library

Members can access various ecosystem resources throughout the programme, through the PartnersConnect Portal and the related modules. These resources are intended to help founders progress more effectively and focus on building their ventures.

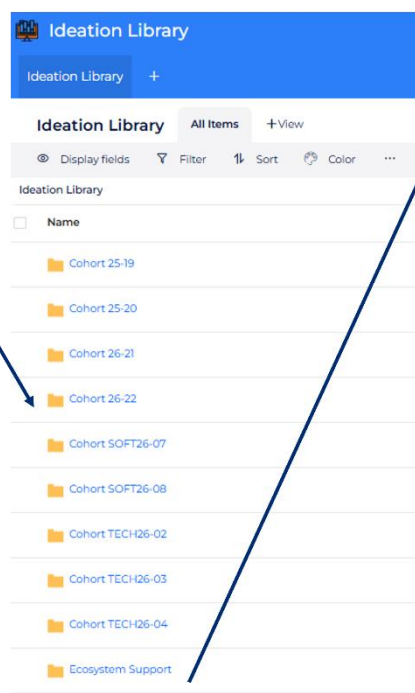


The Ideation Library contains important programme materials including:

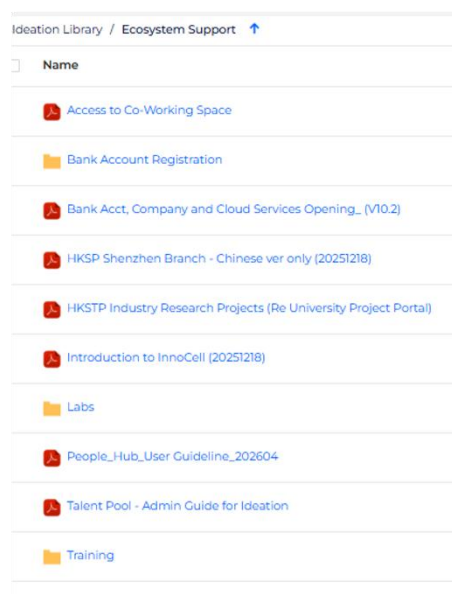
- Milestone guidelines
- FAQs
- Templates
- Training resources
- Cohort-specific information

Members should consult the library before contacting the programme team regarding common programme questions.

Find your Cohort Folder

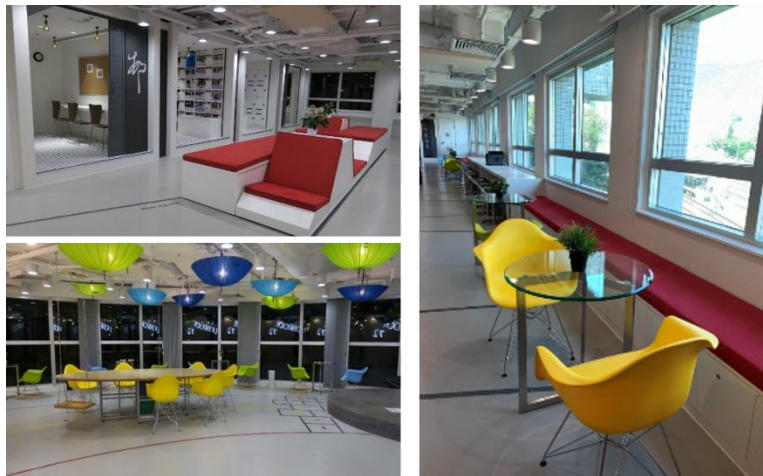


Access the Ecosystem Support



InnoCentre: Co-working Space Access

Eligible members may apply for access to coworking facilities at InnoCentre.



Available facilities include:

- Hot desks
- Common areas

Access Time: 24 hours a day, 7 days a week

Important Notes

- Access is subject to availability.
- Company Members: 2 accesses (including PIC); Individual Members: 1 access (must be PIC)
- InnoCentre cannot be used as a registered company address.
- Users must comply with all applicable rules and regulations.
- You **MUST** bring your own access card when you come to the Centre for identification and access.

For more details, please refer to the “Virtual Access Registration” email sent by the Operation Services colleague along with the duly signed agreement.

Laboratories & Technical Facilities

HKSTP provides access to a range of specialised facilities that support technology development and prototyping.

Facilities include:

- [Hardware Lab](#)
- [Prototyping Lab](#)
- [Flexible Lab](#)
- [Chemical Co-working Centre](#)
- [Sensor Packaging and Integration Lab](#)
- [Medical Device Testing Lab](#)

Separate application and usage requirements may apply.

Partner Logo: Promoting Your HKSTP Affiliation

Eligibility: Company Members. To update to a Company Member, please refer to Chapter 7 > Change Requests > Company Membership Update.

Company Members may be eligible to use the HKSTP Partner Logo in accordance with HKSTP branding guidelines.



The Partner Logo helps communicate your connection with the HKSTP ecosystem and may be used on selected marketing and promotional materials, subject to approval and compliance requirements.

For application details and brand usage guidelines, members should visit [the website](#) or contact brandcheck@hkstp.org for more.

Chapter 7. Administrative Guide

Your Responsibilities as a Member

Participation in the HKSTP Ideation Programme comes with certain responsibilities. To remain in good standing throughout the programme period, members are expected to actively engage with programme activities, meet all required deadlines, and comply with programme requirements.

Failure to fulfil programme obligations may result in milestone failure, delayed grant disbursement, suspension of programme benefits, or termination from the programme.

Stay Connected and Responsive

Members are required to:

- Monitor emails from HKSTP regularly
- Add ideation@hkstp.org to safe sender lists
- Respond to requests within stated deadlines
- Quote their Ideation ID in communications
- Pay attention to programme announcements and deadlines

Meet Programme Requirements

Members must:

- Complete milestone submissions on time
- Complete required training
- Attend mandatory programme activities
- Provide accurate information
- Inform HKSTP of material changes

Maintain Key Member Information

Certain information must remain unchanged throughout the programme period.

Individual Members

- Registered Email Address

Company Members

- Person in Charge (PIC)

- Registered Email Address

Important Notes

- For Company Members, the PIC must remain a shareholder of the company throughout the programme period.
- Changes that affect programme eligibility, grant administration, or funding arrangements may not be approved.
- HKSTP does not support entity changes during the programme period.

Grant Disbursement

Funding support is released in stages based on successful completion of programme milestones and fulfilment of all programme requirements.

To avoid delays in payment processing, members should ensure that all required documents and information are submitted accurately and on time.

To avoid payment delays:

- Ensure all documentation is submitted accurately
- Ensure bank account information matches the Grant Agreement
- Refer to payment advice for actual payment dates

Hong Kong Science and Technology
Parks Corporation
香港科技園公司

PAYMENT ADVICE

Cheque Number :			
Payment Date : 02-SEP-2025			
Supplier Number :			
Payment Batch No. :			
Invoice Date	Invoice Number	Description	Amount Paid (\$)
22-AUG-2025			10,000.00
TOTAL AMOUNT PAID: HKD			10,000.00

For milestone-specific funding amounts and release conditions, please refer to Chapter 2. For key dates and milestones, please refer to the Programme Timeline and Key Dates section in this chapter. For bank account after updating to Company Membership, please refer to the Change Requests section in this chapter.

Change Requests

HKSTP understands that startups evolve over time. Where necessary, certain changes may be permitted during the programme period, subject to approval and compliance with programme policies.

Project Name Change

Members who wish to change their project name must:

- Notify the Ideation Programme Team by email at least one week before the effective date of the new name.
- Ensure that the change does not impact programme eligibility or ongoing assessments.
- Note that project name changes are not permitted after the Second or Third Milestone assessment.

Company Name Change

Members who wish to change their company name must:

- Notify the Ideation Programme Team within one week after the effective date of the name change.
- Complete the required HKSTP name change documentation.
- Provide supporting documents, including the Certificate of Change of Name.
- Note that company name changes are not accepted after the final milestone assessment.

Company Membership Update

Members who wish to update their membership from Individual to Company should notify the Ideation Programme Team and provide the relevant company documents.

To be eligible, the company must:

- Be incorporated as a private company limited by shares
- Have the Person in Charge (PIC) as one of the shareholders
- Have been incorporated in Hong Kong less than two years before the programme application start date
- Not use HKSTP or InnoCentre as its registered business address

Important Notes

- Members whose bank account registration was approved under their Individual Membership are **not required to change to a company bank account**. Any remaining grant disbursements will continue to be made to the approved individual bank account.
- Members who have **not completed or obtained approval for bank account registration** before updating their membership status should contact the Ideation Programme Team for guidance before submitting their bank registration documents.

Members are encouraged to notify HKSTP as early as possible, as administrative changes may affect programme records and grant processing timelines.

Programme Timeline and Key Dates

The Ideation Programme follows a structured 12-month timeline. Members are responsible for tracking important deadlines, milestone submissions, assessment periods, and programme activities. Key dates include:

	Event	Date
	Programme Start	1 st month
	Orientation and Orientation Survey	1 st week of programme start
	Orientation Deck	2 nd week of programme start
	1st Milestone Grant Disbursement (If eligible)	2 nd month
	1st Milestone Completion Due Date	3 rd month
	2nd Milestone Submission Due Date	5 th month
	2nd Milestone Result Announcement	By end of 7 th month
	Invitation to PeopleHub & Level-up Bootcamp (By invite only)	By end of 7 th month
	2nd Milestone Grant Disbursement (If eligible)	8 th 2027
	Level-up Bootcamp	Fast Pass Participants: Eligible for Fast Pass and Secured a 6-month Grace Period for 3rd Milestone
		Other Participants: Secured a 6-month Grace Period for 3rd Milestone
	Level-up Bootcamp Result Announcement	1 Week after Bootcamp
	3rd Milestone (Incubation Application) Submission Due Date	By end of 11 th month
	End-of-Programme Survey	12 th month
	Programme End	End of 12 th month
	3rd Milestone Grant Disbursement (if eligible)	1 month after Incubation Approval

The table above provides a reference of the major programme milestones and important dates. Members should always refer to programme communications for the most up-to-date arrangements and submission requirements.

Chapter 8. Support & Contacts

Getting Support

If you require assistance, clarification or guidance at any point during the programme, please contact the Ideation Programme Team at ideation@hkstp.org.

When contacting the team, please include:

- Your Ideation ID
- Summary of your enquiry

Before Contacting the Team

Many operational questions are already covered in the Ideation Library, including:

- Milestone requirements
- Programme and Milestone FAQs
- Common administrative procedures
- Ecosystem Services

Members are encouraged to consult the relevant resources before reaching out to the programme team.

Useful Links

<https://www.hkstp.org/en/programmes/ideation>

<https://partnersconnect.hkstp.org/>

Final Message

The Ideation Programme is more than a funding programme.

It is an opportunity to validate ideas, develop entrepreneurial capabilities, build meaningful relationships, and prepare for future growth.

We encourage you to stay curious, remain resilient, learn continuously, and actively engage with the opportunities available throughout your journey. The founders who gain the most value from the Ideation Programme are often those who are proactive, curious and willing to engage with the opportunities around them.

We look forward to supporting your venture as you progress from idea to impact.